**FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (FRD)**

**Project C: Dee Bank SME Merchant Onboarding & Settlement Visibility**

**Table**

| | |
|---|---|
| **Document Owner** | **Business Analyst** |
| **Project** | Dee Bank Merchant Onboarding & Settlement Visibility |
| **Version** | 1.0 |
| **Date** | 14 October 2026 |
| **Status** | For Stakeholder Review |
| **Approvals** | Pending |

**Table of Contents**


1. Executive Summary ..... 3
2. Purpose and Scope ..... 3
3. Definitions & Acronyms ..... 4
4. Stakeholders ..... 5
5. Business Requirements .....5-6
6. Functional Requirements .....7-14
7. Non-Functional Requirements .....15-16
8. Data Model & Schema .....16-17
9. APIs & Integrations .....17-18
10. UI Wireframes / Mockups ..... 18-19
11. Acceptance Criteria & Test Cases .....19-20
12. Traceability Matrix .....20-21
13. Assumptions & Constraints ..... 21-22
14. Risks & Mitigations .....22-23

15. Change Log .....24

16. Appendices .....24-25

## 1. Executive Summary

Dee Bank's SME merchant onboarding and settlement communication process is fragmented, applications arrive through multiple channels with no standard checklist, status is tracked across disconnected tools, and settlement timelines are not published. Merchants repeatedly contact support for updates, creating inefficiencies and uncertainties. This FRD translates the business needs defined in the BRD into 10 functional requirements and 5 non-functional requirements for a unified intake portal, shared status system, merchant self-service dashboard, automated notifications, and public settlement schedule. Requirements are prioritized using MoSCoW method and traced back to business objectives.

## 2. Purpose and Scope

Purpose: To define detailed functional and non-functional requirements for the new merchant onboarding and settlement visibility system at Dee Bank. Guiding design, development, and testing teams on exactly what the system must do.

**Scope**

**In Scope:**

- Merchant registration and application submission portal
- Document checklist and eligibility display
- Application status management and internal workflow tracking
- Merchant dashboard showing progress and settlement information
- Automated email/SMS notifications at key milestones
- Public settlement schedule page

- Role based access for merchants, customer support team, onboarding operations team, and finance teams.

**Out of Scope:**

- Core banking system replacement
- Changes to credit risk assessment logic
- Native mobile app development
- Third party payment gateway integration

## 3. Definitions & Acronyms

**Table**

| **Term** | **Definition** |
|---|---|
| BRD | Business Requirements Document defines *what* the business needs |
| FRD | Functional Requirements Document defines *how* the system must behave |
| MoSCoW | Prioritisation framework: Must have, Should have, Could have, Won't have |
| SLA | Service Level Agreement: Agreed response or processing time targets |
| KYC | Know Your Customer: Merchant identity verification process |
| Cut-off | Daily/weekly deadline after which settlement processing moves to the next cycle |
| TO-BE | The proposed improved process or system state |

## 4. Stakeholders

**Table**

| Role | Responsibility |
|---|---|
| Product Owner | Approves requirements, prioritizes scope, signs off acceptance |
| Business Analyst | Defines and documents requirements, manages traceability, facilitates validation |
| IT Lead / Engineering Team | Designs and builds the solution, validates technical feasibility |
| Merchant Users | End users apply, track status, view settlement information |
| Customer Support Team | Assists merchants, accesses internal dashboard, views same data as merchants and notes |
| Onboarding Operations Team | Reviews applications, updates status, manages document requests and complete onboarding |
| Finance & Reconciliation | Maintains settlement schedules, approves public timeline data |
| Compliance / Risk | Reviews all public content, approves data visibility rules |

## 5. Business Requirements

**Table**

| ID | Business Requirement | Priority (MoSCoW) | Notes / Rationale |
|---|---|---|---|
| BR-001 | Unified Application Entry Point, one standard online form as | MUST | Eliminates duplicate data entry across channels |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | primary intake | | |
| BR-002 | Upfront Transparency, document checklist and timeline shown before application starts | MUST | Reduces incomplete submissions and delays |
| BR-003 | Single Source of Truth, central status system shared by all teams | MUST | Eliminates conflicting answers |
| BR-004 | Standard Status Glossary consistent definitions used internally and externally | MUST | Removes confusion and miscommunication |
| BR-005 | Merchant Self-Service Dashboard to view status, next steps, settlement estimate | MUST | Reduces repeated enquiries empowers merchants and allow team to channel energy to another value adding services. |
| BR-006 | Automated Notifications alerts at key milestones | SHOULD | Keeps merchants informed without manual effort |
| BR-007 | Published Settlement Schedule cut-offs, processing rules, holiday impact | MUST | Removes uncertainty, reduces settlement enquiries |
| BR-008 | Controlled Disclosure Framework rules for | MUST | Ensures compliance and data security |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | public versus private settlement data | | |
| BR-009 | Customer Support Team efficiency supports portal mirrors merchant view and internal notes | SHOULD | Enables consistent, fast responses |
| BR-010 | Performance Reporting track enquiries, timelines, adoption rates | COULD | Measures success and guides continuous improvement |

## 6. Functional Requirements

**Table**

| ID | Title | Description | Priority | Inputs | Outputs | Acceptance Criteria (Summary) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FR-001 | Merchant Registration & Login | System allows merchants to create an account with email and password, verify email, and allows | MUST | Full name, business name, email, password | Account created, verification email, login token | Given valid details of account created & verification sent, shown. |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | secured login | | | | |
| FR-002 | Pre-Application Guidance | System displays document checklist, eligibility criteria, and estimated timeline before application starts | MUST | Merchant selects business type | Checklist, requirements list, estimated processing time displayed | Given merchant lands on application page, requirements becomes visible immediately, no login required to view |
| FR-003 | Application Form & Submission | System presents standard form, validates completeness, saves draft and confirms receipt | MUST | Business details, owner information and documents are uploaded | Submission reference number and confirmation sent via email | Given all required fields are complete, submissions are successful |
| FR | Status | Ops/Admin | MUST | New | Status | Given |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| -004 | Management (Internal) | users update application status, system records who, when and why | | status value, optional comment, updated ID | history log updated, timestamp captured | authorised user changes status, change logged, unauthorised user's access is denied |
| FR-005 | Merchant Status Dashboard | Merchant sees current stage, next action, estimated completion, settlement status | MUST | Merchant login ID | Current status label, progress bar, next steps, settlement date (if available) | Given merchant logs in then dashboard loads within 3seconds. If there's no application yet, Start Application prompt |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | shows |
| FR-006 | Automated Notifications | System sends email/SMS at: submission received, requested documents are reviewed and approved. Then settlement is initiated | SHOULD | Status change, merchant contact preference are shown on dashboard | Email/SMS event logged upon delivery | Given status moves to Documents Requested, notification sent within 15 minutes and merchant can opt out except for mandatory updates |
| FR-007 | Public Settlement Schedule Page | Displays cut-off day/time, processing duration, weekend/holiday deferral rules | MUST | No publicly accessible page | Schedule table and FAQs | Given any user visits page, schedule visible without login, |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | content approved by Compliance before publication |
| FR-008 | Settlement Estimate Display | Dashboard shows estimated settlement date when available, clearly labelled as estimate | MUST | Approval date, settlement schedule rules, cut-off calendar | Subject to check Estimated date and review displayed Label | Given application is approved, date is calculated and shown. Given date is unavailable, check back soon message is displayed |
| FR- | Support Team | Customer support team | SHOULD | Support staff | Merchant status, | Given support |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 009 | Dashboard | view same merchant data and internal notes field and audit log of all status changes | | login, selected merchant ID | timeline, settlement info, notes history, audit trail | opens merchant record, same view as merchant and internal notes are visible, notes not editable by merchants |
| FR-010 | Admin Reporting & Export | Admin users can view enquiry volume trends, average stage duration, dashboard adoption rate | COULD | Date range filter, export format selection | CSV/PDF report, summary metrics | Given admin selects date range, data loads. Given export requested, file downloads |

## 7. Detailed Functional Requirement: Full Template Example

**ID:** FR-005

**Title:** Merchant Status Dashboard

**Description:** Secure, personalized dashboard displaying application progress and settlement information.

**Priority:** MUST

**Rationale:** Eliminates repeated status enquiries, gives merchants transparency and reduces support workload.

**Inputs:** Merchant user ID, application ID, current status, status history, settlement schedule data.

**Outputs:** Current stage label, visual progress bar, next action description, estimated completion date, settlement status/date, last updated timestamp

**UI Behaviour:** Dashboard loads on login, clean 4-section layout, no technical jargon, settlement date clearly marked as estimated and Help link is to contact support.

**Business Rules:** Only the merchant and authorized internal staff can view that specific application, status glossary terms match internal definitions, and settlement dates hidden until application approved.

APIs: GET /api/merchant/{id}/dashboard, returns combined status and settlement data

Data Model: Applications table (status id, submitted at, approved at, merchant id); Settlement Schedule table (cutoff_day, cutoff_time, processing days, holiday rules)

Dependencies: FR-001 (Authentication), FR-003 (Submission), FR-004 (Status Management), FR-007 (Settlement Schedule)

Security & Permissions: Merchants, view only their own dashboard, Customer support team view all merchants dashboard and notes, Onboarding Operations and Finance team view and update status Compliance and view audit logs.

8. **Acceptance Criteria:**

GIVEN a merchant submitted an application

WHEN they log into their dashboard

THEN they see their current status, what happens next, and an estimated completion date

GIVEN the settlement date is not yet available

WHEN they view the settlement section

THEN it clearly shows "Being reviewed, check back soon" instead of a blank or incorrect date

**Test Cases:**

- Merchant with no application sees "Get Started" prompt
- Application at Documents Requested shows upload button and deadline hint
- Approved application shows settlement estimate and disclaimer label
- Unauthorised access attempt, redirected to login page
-

9. **Non-Functional Requirements**

**Table**

| **ID** | **Category** | **Requirement** | **Notes / Open Questions** |
|---|---|---|---|
| NFR-001 | Performance | Dashboard loads in < 3 seconds on 4G connection, page refresh under 2 | Confirmed target |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | seconds | |
| NFR-002 | Usability | Responsive design works correctly on mobile, tablet, and desktop, no horizontal scrolling on mobile | Confirmed target |
| NFR-003 | Security, Data Protection | Merchant personal and business data encrypted in transit (TLS) and at rest; access requires secure login, role-based permissions enforced, and password minimum length 8 characters. | Confirmed. Aligns with data protection standards |
| NFR-004 | Security, Audit Trail | All status changes, logins, and note edits logged with user ID, timestamp, and IP address, logs immutable for 7 years | Confirmed. Compliance requirement |
| NFR-005 | Availability | System available 99.5% excluding scheduled maintenance (maintenance window: Sundays 2–4 AM), scheduled downtime communicated 3 days in advance | Proposed. SLA review pending |
| NFR-006 | Compliance | All public facing settlement content reviewed and approved by Compliance before release, no sensitive internal data exposed externally | Confirmed. (Mandatory process) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| NFR-007 | Accessibility | Forms and navigation usable via keyboard; colour contrast meets WCAG AA; alt text for images | Proposed. To be confirmed |

## 10. Data Model & Schema

**Table**

| Table Name | Key Fields | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Merchants | Merchant id, Business name, Contact name, Email, created at and status | Merchant account and contact details |
| Applications | App Id, merchant id, status, submitted at, approved at, reviewer notes | Main application record and lifecycle |
| Status History | History id, app id, new status, changed by, changed at, comment | Audit trail of all status changes |
| Documents | Doc Id, App Id, filename, file type, uploaded at, verified | Supporting documents uploaded by merchant |
| Settlement Schedule | Scheduled ID, cutoff_day, cutoff_time, processing days, holiday adjustment | Publicly visible settlement calculation rules |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Internal Notes | Note Id, App Id, Author Id, content, created at | Support Team and Onboarding Operations team private communication are not visible to merchants |

## 11. APIs & Integrations

**Table**

| **API / Integration** | **Purpose** | **Authentication Method** | **Status** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Merchant Authentication API | Login, registration, password reset, session management | JWT Token | Proposed |
| Application Status API | Create, read, update application records, return status history | API Key and OAuth2 | Proposed |
| Settlement Schedule API | Return cut-off dates, estimated settlement date for display | API Key (read only) | Awaiting Finance system review |
| Notification Service API | Send transactional email/SMS at status milestones | API Key and Signature | Proposed vendor To Be Determined |
| Finance System (Read Only) | Pull settlement confirmed dates (not estimates) for | Restricted API access (read only) | Awaiting Validation. IT to confirm |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | approved merchants | | feasibility |

## 12. UI Wireframes / Mockups

**Table**

| Screen ID | Screen Name | Purpose | Key Elements |
|---|---|---|---|
| SC-001 | Landing and Guidance Page | Show requirements before merchant applies | Checklist, eligibility, timeline, "Start Application" button appears |
| SC-002 | Application Form | Capture merchant details and upload documents | Step-by-step sections, save draft and progress indicator |
| SC-003 | Merchant Dashboard | Primary merchant view: status and settlement info | Current stage card, progress bar, next steps, settlement estimate and timeline link |
| SC-004 | Settlement Schedule | Public page, no login needed | Cut-off table, processing explanation, holiday rules, FAQ |
| SC-005 | Support Console | Internal team view all merchants and notes | Search bar, merchant list, unified status view, internal notes panel, audit log |

***Wireframe visuals:*** *Placeholder to be created in Figma once requirements are finalized*

## 13. Acceptance Criteria & Test Cases (Detailed)

### FR-005 — Merchant Dashboard Acceptance Criteria

**Table**

| # | Given, When, Then | Expected Result |
|---|---|---|
| AC-005.1 | GIVEN a merchant is logged in<br>WHEN they visit their dashboard<br>THEN current status, next action, and estimated date are displayed | All 3 elements visible, layout clean and dates are clearly labelled "Estimated" |
| AC-005.2 | GIVEN settlement is not yet calculated<br>WHEN merchant views settlement section<br>THEN a helpful message is shown instead of a blank date | Message: "Settlement timeline will appear once your application is approved" |
| AC-005.3 | GIVEN another merchant tries to access a different merchant's dashboard URL<br>THEN access is denied and they are redirected to login | Error: "You do not have permission to view this page" |
| AC-005.4 | GIVEN status changes internally<br>WHEN merchant refreshes dashboard<br>THEN the new status appears within 60 seconds | Status updates without needing a new login |

## 14. Traceability Matrix

**Table**

| Business Requirement ID | Functional Requirement ID | Non-Functional Requirement | Test Case Ref | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| BR-001 Unified Entry Point | FR-001, FR-002, FR-003 | NFR-002 Usability | AC-003.x | Draft |
| BR-002 Upfront Transparency | FR-002 | NFR-002 Usability | AC-002.x | Draft |
| BR-003 Single Source of Truth | FR-004 | NFR-004 Audit Trail | AC-004.x | Draft |
| BR-005 Merchant Dashboard | FR-005, FR-008 | NFR-001 Performance, NFR-002 Usability, NFR-003 Security | AC-005.1–005.4 | Draft |
| BR-006 Notifications | FR-006 | NFR-005 Availability | AC-006.x | Draft |
| BR-007 Settlement Schedule | FR-007, FR-008 | NFR-006 Compliance | AC-007.x | Awaiting Finance |
| BR-009 Support Efficiency | FR-009 | NFR-004 Audit Trail | AC-009.x | Draft |
| BR-010 Reporting | FR-010 | — | AC-010.x | Draft |

## 15. Assumptions & Constraints

### Assumptions

- Merchants have reliable internet access and an email address
- Existing Finance settlement system can expose estimated dates via read-only access
- Compliance will approve general timeline information for public display while detailed breakdowns remain internal
- SMS notification costs are acceptable within project budget, while email is the primary channel for contacts.

### Constraints

- No direct write access to core banking/Finance systems, data pulled one-way only.
- Budget allocated in phases, full dashboard build subject to Phase 1 process improvements approval.
- Legacy system API limitations may delay real-time settlement data as daily estimate updates may be acceptable initially
- All public content requires Compliance sign-off and allow 3 working days review time

### Risks & Mitigations

### Table

| Risk | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation Strategy | Owner | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Merchants | Medium | High | Personal | Support | Proposed |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| continue emailing support instead of using portal | | | invite on approval, prominent "Check here first" banner in email signatures with a 2-week transition period | Lead | |
| Settlement data cannot be auto-pulled from Finance system | Low | Medium | Manual daily export option as fallback; display static schedule page initially; enhance later | IT & Finance | Awaiting Validation |
| Compliance rejects some public | Medium | Medium | Submit draft content early, | Compliance Officer | In Progress |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| settlement details | | | prepare simplified version as backup and agree minimum safe info first | | |
| Status definitions cause internal disagreement | Low | Medium | Facilitated 1-hour workshop, visual glossary document and formal team sign-off | Business Analyst | Proposed |

## 16. Change Log

**Table**

| Version | Date | Author / Editor | Summary of Changes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 0.1 | 14 Oct 2026 | Business Analyst | Initial draft (full FRD created from template) |

**Appendix A: Relevant Documents & References**

- BRD for Dee Bank Merchant Onboarding & Settlement Visibility

- Elicitation Plan & Findings Log
- Source document (Project brief)
- Settlement Schedule Draft and Finance review pending are awaiting signatures
- Reference document [Compliance Guidelines and Public Information Disclosure]

**Appendix B: Glossary**

**Table**

| **Term** | **Meaning** |
|---|---|
| Application | Merchant request to join Dee Bank's SME programme |
| Cut-off | Daily/weekly deadline, applications ARE approved after this roll to next settlement cycle |
| Estimated Settlement Date | Projected date funds arrive, subject to review, holds, and bank processing times |
| Merchant Dashboard | Secure portal for merchants to track their own application and settlement info |
| Status Glossary | Standard definitions for terminologies (one meaning across all teams) |
| TO-BE | The improved, future process and system state being designed |